ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET A

Chapter 1: **A Letter to God** (First Flight) | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 20

SECTION — A — Answers — 6 Marks

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
1	**(a)** A downpour or at least a shower — *The field needed rain*	1
2	**(c)** fives — *'New coins'*	1
3	**(a)** Sadness — *The crop was destroyed*	1
4	**(a)** a plague of locusts — *'A plague of locusts would have left more'*	1
5	**(b)** Sunday — *'The following Sunday, at daybreak'*	1
6	**(d)** One hundred pesos — *To sow his field again*	1

SECTION — B — Answers — 4 Marks

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
7	**(i)** The hail had destroyed the corn and stripped every leaf from the trees.	1
	(ii) He compared it with a plague of locusts, which would have left more.	1
	(iii) They feared that they would go hungry as there would be no corn.	1
	(iv) Swarm (of locusts).	1

SECTION — C — Answers — 4 Marks

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
8	He collected money from his staff, friends and himself and sent it to Lencho; he signed 'God' so that Lencho's faith in God would not be shaken.	2
9	To him the rain meant a good harvest and money; so big drops seemed like ten-cent pieces and small ones like fives.	2

SECTION — D — Answers — 6 Marks

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
10	Rain began as Lencho had predicted; then a strong wind and big hailstones; hail fell for an hour and the field turned white; corn and flowers were destroyed and no leaf was left; Lencho's soul was filled with sadness; the family feared hunger but had hope in God.	3
	OR: He was moved by Lencho's faith and wanted to keep it alive; he needed money, so he asked employees and friends and gave part of his salary but could collect only a little over half of the hundred pesos.	3
11	Hard-working (an ox of a man); simple and naive; had unshakable faith in God (wrote to God, no surprise at the money); but suspicious of others and ungrateful (called postal staff crooks).	3
	OR: Human vs nature — the hailstorm destroys Lencho's crop; human vs human — Lencho accuses the post office staff of being crooks though they helped him; the postmaster's help contrasts with Lencho's distrust.	3

Evaluator's note: Answers given are model answers / value points; accept any other relevant and correct response in the candidate's own words. For writing tasks, marks are for format, content, organisation and accuracy of language. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET B

Chapter 1: **A Letter to God** (First Flight) | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 20

SECTION — A — Answers — 6 Marks

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
1	**(d)** wrote to God and expected a reply — *Faith in God*	1
2	**(c)** Seventy pesos — *Lencho counted seventy pesos*	1
3	**(b)** God — *To protect Lencho's faith*	1
4	**(b)** The money was less than he had asked for — *He counted the money*	1
5	**(d)** the post office employees — *'A bunch of crooks'*	1
6	**(a)** the people who helped Lencho were called crooks by him — *Unexpected opposite of what is expected*	1

SECTION — B — Answers — 4 Marks

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
7	**(i)** He found it funny that a letter was addressed to God.	1
	(ii) He was struck by the farmer's faith in God.	1
	(iii) He asked his employees and friends and gave part of his own salary.	1
	(iv) Kindness / generosity (and respect for another's faith).	1

SECTION — C — Answers — 4 Marks

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
8	He was angry as only seventy pesos had come. He wrote asking God to send the rest, but not through the mail as the post office employees were crooks.	2
9	Rain turned into a hailstorm with a strong wind; hail destroyed the corn, leaves and flowers and made the field white.	2

SECTION — D — Answers — 6 Marks

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
10	After the crop was ruined he was left with only one hope, help from God; he wrote that his family would go hungry and he needed a hundred pesos to sow the field again and live until the next crop.	3
	OR: Faith kept Lencho hopeful in despair, and it inspired the postmaster; but his blind faith made him sure God could not make a mistake and he blamed honest people for the shortage.	3
11	He was a fat, amiable man; he laughed at the address but turned serious, admired Lencho's faith, wished he had such faith and decided to answer the letter to preserve it.	3
	OR: People can be generous (postmaster), but also ungrateful and suspicious (Lencho); faith can be touching but unreasonable; kindness is often unrecognised.	3

Evaluator's note: Answers given are model answers / value points; accept any other relevant and correct response in the candidate's own words. For writing tasks, marks are for format, content, organisation and accuracy of language. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted.